

EmacEArt Skybox URP Shader

User Guide -- 19th Century Courtyards

What is this?

The EmacEArt Skybox URP Shader is a fully procedural sky included with this asset pack. It creates a dynamic, painterly sky entirely from math -- no photo textures needed. The sun, atmosphere, clouds, and stars are all generated in real time and can be freely adjusted to match any time of day, weather condition, or artistic mood. It works with Unity's Universal Render Pipeline (URP).

Without this shader vs. with this shader

Without the shader	With the shader
Unity default solid or gradient sky -- no atmosphere	Rich atmospheric gradient from zenith to horizon to ground
No sun disc or glow	Procedural sun with soft glow, follows the scene's main directional light
Flat uniform sky color, no depth	Atmospheric haze fades colors naturally toward the horizon
No clouds without a separate cloud texture asset	Built-in animated procedural clouds with 5 style presets
No night sky without a cubemap texture	Optional star field with adjustable intensity and sharpness
No color grading on the sky itself	Built-in exposure, contrast, saturation and lift/gamma/gain controls

Features at a glance

Zenith, Horizon and Ground colors -- Three independent color zones blend smoothly across the sky dome. Horizon sharpness and offset let you place the color boundary exactly where you want it.

Procedural sun -- A crisp sun disc with a soft glow halo. The sun automatically follows your scene's Main Directional Light, so rotating the light changes the time of day instantly. Manual direction is also available.

Atmospheric haze -- A tinted haze layer wraps around the horizon, simulating aerial perspective. Adjust strength and falloff to go from a clear day to a thick misty morning.

Sky gradient overlay -- An optional directional color sweep adds a warm or cool gradient across the sky -- useful for sunsets, golden hours, or dramatic lighting.

Animated clouds (5 styles) -- Standard, Feathered, Round, Diagonal and Cubic cloud styles, each with independent coverage, density, softness, stretch and scroll speed controls. Toggle on or off with one checkbox.

Star field -- A cubemap-based star field for night or dusk scenes. Control intensity, threshold and sharpness. Toggle on or off independently from clouds.

Built-in color grading -- Exposure, contrast, saturation, and full Lift/Gamma/Gain controls applied directly to the sky output -- no post-processing volume needed for sky color correction.

How to adjust it

Select the material **EA_Skybox** in the Project window. The Inspector groups all controls by category. The defaults are tuned for this pack. Quick starting points:

- Change **Zenith / Horizon Color** to shift the overall sky tone.
- Rotate the scene's **Directional Light** to move the sun and change time of day.
- Enable **Clouds** and pick a Style preset for instant overcast or partly cloudy skies.
- Enable **Stars** and lower **Stars Threshold** for a denser star field at night.
- Use **Exposure** to brighten or darken the entire sky without touching individual colors.